## The Wahhabi-Salafi Nexus

Apart from this coordinated approach of overt and covert pressure by China and Pakistan in the state, there is another dimension to this problem that has altered the perception of a majority of the inhabitants of the valley. This has been the Wahhabisation of Islam in the valley since the insurgency started in 1989. This is an austere, puritanical interpretation of Islam promoted by Saudi Arabia that is making deep inroads into the valley due to the efforts of the Jamaat Ahl-e-Hadith, which calls itself a religious and welfare organisation.

Across the border in Pakistan, Markaz-e-Jamiat Ahl-e-Hadith of Allama Sajid Mir is the best-known political organisation promoting the Wahhabi line, apart from Hafiz Jama'at-ud-Dawa which was formerly known as Dawatul Irshad with its *jihadi* wing, Lashkar-e-Taiba. The greatest asset of Jamaat Ahl-e-Hadith is its central Wifaq al-Madaris which looks after the Wahhabi seminaries all over Pakistan. It has eight subsidiary organisations, among which the Ahl-e-Hadith Youth Force is quite important. Because of its ability to mobilise and act, it is often called the 'spine' of the Jamiat. The next important subsidiary is Tehreek al-Mujahideen which is a fighting outfit headed by Sheikh Jameelur Rehman who also heads the ISI-controlled United Jihad Council, the apex body of all militias fighting in the Kashmir jihad. It trains near Muzaffarabad in Azad Kashmir and has resisted efforts for a merger with Lashkar-e-Taiba. Tehreek al-Mujahideen is funded by Al-Haramain Islamic Foundation which funnels money from Saudi Arabia into South Asia. The contact with Saudi Arabia was established after the Ahl-e-Hadith of Pakistan started a movement of protection of Mecca and Medina after the Shia tried to hold meetings at Kaaba. In 1985, Imam Kaaba and a representative professor of Medina University became members of this foundation. Mansur bin Abdul Rehman al-Qazi of Al-Haramain Islamic Foundation declared in the Tehreek journal *Shahadat* in July 2000 that he was satisfied by the Tehreek's spreading of the Salafi faith in India-held Kashmir.[45] Tehreek al-Mujahideen claims that 500 of its warriors died in jihad in Kashmir after killing 3,000 Indian